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Candidate surname	Other names
Centre Number	Candidate Number

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9-1)

Tuesday 9 June 2026

Afternoon (Time: 1 hour 20 minutes)

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 31: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918-39

Paper
reference

1HI0/31

You must have:

Sources/Interpretations Booklet (enclosed)

Total Marks

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- Answer **all** questions in Section A and Section B.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided
- *there may be more space than you need.*

Information

- The total mark for this paper is 52.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets
- *use this as a guide as to how much time to spend on each question.*

- The marks available for spelling, punctuation, grammar and use of specialist terminology are clearly indicated.

Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Try to divide your time equally between Section A and Section B.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

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SECTION A

Answer ALL questions in this section.

- 1 Give two things you can infer from Source A about cultural changes in the Weimar Republic. (4)

Source A: From a letter written by a traditionalist schoolmaster, Bernhard Rust, living in Hanover, October 1927.

"This city, once so quiet, is now infested with modernism. The women cut their hair like boys, wear painted faces, and smoke openly in the cafés. At the local gallery, the beautiful landscapes have been replaced by disgusting, distorted paintings by Dix and Grosz, which highlight only the dirt and depravity of our nation. The local theater is presenting plays that mock our traditional German values. When I speak out, my colleagues tell me that this is 'freedom of expression' guaranteed by our new constitution. If this is the 'Golden Age' that Stresemann speaks of, it is an age of moral decline and the death of German culture."

Complete the table below to explain your answer.

(i) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

(ii) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

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- 2 Explain why there was a "Golden Age" of cultural development in Weimar Germany in the years 1924-29. (12)

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- Expressionism
- The Bauhaus school

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

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[illegible]

[illegible]

3 Explain why the Nazi Party was reorganised in the years 1924–28.

(12)

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- Landsberg Prison / Mein Kampf
- Gauleiters

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

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[illegible]

SECTION B

For use with Section B, Answer ALL questions.

Source B: From a secret Gestapo report on religious attitudes in Upper Bavaria, July 1937.

"We must report that the influence of the Catholic Church on the rural population remains unbroken. The Nazi spirit cannot penetrate these districts because the local population is entirely under the influence of the priests. These people prefer to believe what the priests say from the pulpit rather than the words of our best party speakers. When our officials attempted to remove crucifixes from the local schoolrooms, women gathered in protest, and we had to restore them to prevent civil unrest. The Concordat prevents us from making direct arrests of these priests during church services, which they exploit to spread subtle criticisms of the government's youth policies."

Source C: From a sermon preached by Pastor Martin Niemöller in Berlin, June 1937.

"We have no more desire than our fathers to stand in judgment over our rulers, but we must obey God rather than men. Our brother pastors are being arrested because they spoke the truth. The government's Reich Church seeks to replace the Cross of Christ with the Swastika, and to force our children into youth organisations that teach them to worship a man. We are told that if we remain silent, the Church will have peace. But I say to you, a silent Church is a dead Church. We must speak out, even if it leads us to the concentration camps."

Interpretation 1: From *The Third Reich* by Dr. Elizabeth Wilmott, published in 1997.

"The Christian Churches in Germany were largely successful in resisting the Nazi regime's attempts to achieve total control over religious life. Despite intense pressure, both the Catholic and Protestant Churches prevented the total Nazification of their institutions. The Concordat of 1933 protected the Catholic Church's independence, and when Hitler broke this agreement, the Pope's encyclical *Mit Brennender Sorge* was successfully read in churches across the nation, showing the limits of Nazi power. In the Protestant Church, the Confessing Church led a brave struggle that prevented Ludwig Müller's Reich Church from dominating German Protestants, proving that religious faith remained a powerful barrier to totalitarian control."

Interpretation 2: From *Coercion and Consent* by Professor Richard Bessel, published in 2004.

"Christian opposition to the Nazi regime was extremely limited, defensive, and ultimately failed to challenge the wider atrocities of the state. The vast majority of

church leaders conformed to the regime because they shared Hitler's hatred of communism and feared the destruction of their institutions. When pastors like Niemöller spoke out, their protests were strictly limited to defending church independence and religious education; they did not protest against the police state, the banning of political parties, or the persecution of the Jews. The state successfully neutralized the churches through selective terror, arresting outspoken individuals while leaving the broader, compliant institutions intact."

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Enquiry: Religious opposition to the Nazi regime in the years 1933-39

3(a) How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into religious opposition to the Nazi regime in the years 1933–39? Explain your answer, using Sources B and C and your knowledge of the historical context. (8)

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3(b) Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about religious opposition to the Nazi regime in the years 1933–39. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations. (4)

3(c) Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about religious opposition to the Nazi regime in the years 1933–39. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4)

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